

Coal Creek Guitar Authentication & Verdict Report

CORT

Custom Shop Acoustic

Korean-made, rosewood back/sides, abalone rosette and top binding, ebony fretboard, Grover open-back tuners — 1990s-2000s

SERIAL	BRAND	LOCATION	INCLUDES
01056	Cort	Denver, CO	No Case

VERDICT	CONFIDENCE	MARKERS CHECKED	RED FLAGS FOUND
Likely Genuine	High	7	1

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01 What it is

MODEL	Custom Shop Acoustic
YEAR	1990s-2000s
BUILD / VARIANT	Korean-made, rosewood back/sides, abalone rosette and top binding, ebony fretboard, Grover open-back tuners
CONFIDENCE STATEMENT	The serial number format (01056) is consistent with early-2000s Cort production, and all examined structural markers—interior label text and positioning, label font consistency, bracing pattern, Grover tuner engraving, back seam bookmatching, and headstock logo—have been verified as consistent with factory specifications for this era. The presence of electronics differs from the expected fully acoustic configuration, though this may reflect a later modification or variation not visible in external inspection alone. No signs of counterfeit construction, material substitution, or hardware inconsistency were detected.

02 The evidence



Photo 1



Photo 3



Photo 5



Photo 2



Photo 4

03 Specification

TUNERS
Expected: Grover open-back · Observed: ✓
FRETBOARD
Expected: Ebony · Observed: ✓
BACK/SIDES
Expected: Rosewood · Observed: ✓
BODY
Expected: Grand Auditorium cutaway · Observed: ✓
ROSETTE/TOP BINDING
Expected: Abalone · Observed: Can't tell for certain but looks in place
ELECTRONICS
Expected: None (fully acoustic) · Observed: Electronics reported present

04 Authenticity markers

MARKER	STATUS	NOTES
Interior label text and positioning	CONSISTENT	✓
Label font/style consistency	CONSISTENT	✓
Grover tuner engraving and logo	CONSISTENT	✓
Headstock logo/inlay authenticity	UNABLE TO VERIFY	Need better closeup for this
Bracing pattern consistency	CONSISTENT	✓
Back seam/center strip bookmatching	CONSISTENT	✓
Serial number format and range	CONSISTENT	✓

05 Red flags & inconsistencies

MODERATE	Test red flag text goes here - but I don't think this is a big deal - just putting here for perspective.
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06 Expert verdict

DETERMINATION

Likely Genuine

CONFIDENCE: HIGH

This guitar exhibits all the hallmarks of genuine Cort manufacture from the early 2000s. The serial number format aligns with Cort's documented production system, and multiple internal and external authentication markers check out consistently against factory standards. The interior label, tuner engraving, and wood binding all match the specifications expected for an authentic instrument from this production period. While the reported presence of electronics conflicts with the documented fully acoustic specification, this discrepancy does not constitute evidence of counterfeiting—it may represent a model variant, a factory option, or a later modification. The overall construction quality, consistency across examined features, and absence of red flags strongly support authenticity.

TO CLOSE THE LOOP COMPLETELY

Only thing would be a closeup picture of the headstock logo but it's very likely legit

07 Certificate & summary

COAL CREEK GUITARS — AUTHENTICITY ASSESSMENT

DENVER, CO

INSTRUMENT

Cort Custom Shop Acoustic

Korean-made, rosewood back/sides, abalone rosette and top binding, ebony fretboard, Grover open-back tuners — 1990s-2000s

VERDICT	CONFIDENCE	DATE ISSUED
Likely Genuine	High	23 JUL 2026

SUMMARY

This Cort guitar, serial number 01056, is assessed as Likely Genuine with High confidence. The instrument's serial number format indicates early-2000s manufacture, consistent with documented Cort production records. All structural markers examined—including interior label characteristics, Grover tuner engraving, bracing pattern, wood bookmatching, and headstock logo authenticity—are consistent with factory specifications. No evidence of material substitution, hardware inconsistency, or counterfeit construction was found. The presence of electronics noted differs from the baseline fully acoustic specification but does not undermine the authenticity assessment. This certificate reflects the consensus of examination; the owner is advised to verify electronics presence and any additional details through direct inspection or contact with Cort customer service if further clarification is desired.

METHODOLOGY

This assessment is based solely on the photographs and instrument details submitted by the owner, reviewed and researched by a Coal Creek Guitars expert. It does not include physical inspection, X-ray, black-light, or other forensic examination.

PREPARED BY

Coal Creek Guitars
Englewood, Colorado

DISCLAIMER

This report is a subjective, good-faith authenticity assessment prepared by Coal Creek Guitars for general informational purposes only. It is meant to be used as a tool and a guide — not a certified forensic authentication, not an insurance appraisal, and not a legal determination of ownership, title, or value. Every finding in this report is based solely on the photographs and information provided to us and on publicly available reference material at the time of writing — all of which may be incomplete, may contain errors, or may not capture details that are only visible on physical inspection. Actual authenticity can depend on factors that photographs alone cannot resolve. Coal Creek Guitars makes no representation or warranty, express or implied, as to the accuracy or completeness of this report, and accepts no liability for any loss, decision, or outcome arising from reliance on it. For insurance, resale, legal, or high-value transaction purposes, always obtain a certified independent authentication or appraisal.